Request for Proposal (RFP)

Cloud Modernization of the GIA Customer Servicing Platform

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1. Background and Objective

Global Insurance Associates (GIA) operates a legacy on-premises customer servicing platform that handles policy administration, claims intake, and customer self-service. The current system runs on aging virtual machines in a single data center and cannot meet peak seasonal demand. GIA seeks a partner to design and implement a modernized, cloud-native platform on Amazon Web Services (AWS). The solution must improve availability, elasticity, security posture, and developer velocity while controlling operating cost.

2. Scope of Work

The selected vendor is expected to deliver a target architecture and a phased migration plan covering the following capabilities:

- A public-facing web and mobile self-service portal for policyholders.
- A policy administration service and a claims intake service, exposed through well-defined APIs.
- An event-driven integration layer connecting servicing, billing, and notification workflows.
- A data platform for operational reporting and near-real-time analytics.
- Identity, authentication, and fine-grained authorization for internal and external users.

3. Functional Requirements

- Policyholders can view policies, download documents, and submit claims online with file attachments.
- Claims submitted online must be validated, persisted durably, and routed to the appropriate processing queue.
- Customer service representatives can search and update policy records with a full audit trail.
- The platform must send email and SMS notifications for claim status changes.
- Reporting users can run daily and monthly operational reports without impacting transactional workloads.

4. Non-Functional Requirements

- Availability target of 99.95% for customer-facing services, with no single point of failure.

- The architecture must span multiple Availability Zones and support a documented disaster-recovery approach.
- Elastic scaling to handle a 5x traffic increase during open-enrollment periods.
- All data encrypted at rest and in transit; secrets managed centrally and never stored in code.
- End-to-end request tracing, centralized logging, and actionable alarms for each major component.
- Infrastructure defined as code and deployed through an automated pipeline.

5. Security and Compliance

GIA handles personally identifiable information and is subject to regulatory audit. The solution must enforce least-privilege access, network segmentation between public and private tiers, and continuous monitoring. Public entry points should be protected by a web application firewall and a content delivery network. Administrative access must require multi-factor authentication.

6. Preferred AWS Building Blocks

GIA has an existing AWS footprint and prefers managed services to reduce operational overhead. Vendors may propose the most appropriate services, but the following are considered a good baseline:

- Containerized microservices running on a managed container platform, fronted by an application load balancer.
- A managed relational database for policy and claims data, with read replicas for reporting.
- Object storage for uploaded claim documents and static web assets.
- A managed message queue and event bus for asynchronous integration.
- A content delivery network and web application firewall in front of the public portal.
- Centralized identity, secrets management, encryption keys, monitoring, and log aggregation.

7. Deliverables

- A target Business, Application, and AWS Deployment architecture.
- A phased migration roadmap with milestones and rollback strategy.
- Infrastructure-as-code templates and a CI/CD pipeline.
- An operational runbook covering monitoring, scaling, and incident response.

8. Evaluation Criteria

Proposals will be evaluated on architectural soundness, security, resilience, total cost of ownership, delivery approach, and relevant experience. Vendors should clearly state assumptions and highlight any trade-offs in their proposed design.